

Shashi Gowda

Software Engineer ★ Computer Scientist ★ Product Developer

I like to build beautiful products that are enjoyable and fast.

I am a generalist with experience in **full stack development, product design, user experience development, performance engineering, and programming language development.**

I have a **PhD in computational science from MIT** where I **built modeling software on top of the Julia language.**

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Education



Massachusetts Institute of Technology

2018 Sep – 2024 May

Ph. D in Computational Science and Mathematics

Thesis: Symbolic-numeric programming in scientific computing

Advisor: Prof. Alan Edelman **GPA: 4.7/5**



Natioinal Institute of Technology Karnataka

2010 Aug – 2014 Apr

B. Tech in Information Technology

CGPA: 8.06/10

Work Experience



ZeroEntropy Inc (YC W25)

2025 Jul – present

Founding Engineer

Worked on building features on a high-availability, high-traffic SaaS. Worked on AI evals, and AWS Marketplace deployments of ZeroEntropy's reranker models. **Skills:** Python, Typescript, React



Sailplane PBC

2024 Aug – 2025 May

Senior AI Engineer

Developed a hierarchical planning agent with high rate of success and reliability. My role: agentic AI dev, product design and engineering. Built the version pivotal to Sailplane's SAFE round. Lead development of many iterations of the agent and its UX.

Skills: Elixir, OTP, LLM & RAG, agents, Gen UI, Product Dev



Massachusetts Institute of Technology

2018 – 2024

Graduate Researcher

Built tools for differentiable programming and scientific computing. My thesis project Symbolics.jl, is a symbolic programming platform used as the lingua-franca of the Scientific Modeling ecosystem in Julia, supporting over **70 scientific simulation packages** with fast gradients of complex physical processes.

Skills: Programming Language Design, Program synthesis, Numerical Computing, Symbolic Systems, Compiler development, Performance Engineering, Julia, Scheme



JuliaHub Inc

2016 Sep – 2018 Aug

Principal Software Engineer

Built a high-performance, distributed analytical database, JuliaDB, achieving 1.5-10x query and indexing performance compared to pandas on various benchmarks. Built distributed indexed tables (now part of larger ecosystem) with performance beating Spark. Lead custom client deployments.

Skills: Analytical DBs, Extreme Performance, ML algorithms at scale, Distributed computing, Parser Generators



CSAIL, MIT

2014 Sep – 2016 Aug

Research Software Engineer

Built a distributed array framework. Built experimental UI frameworks for scientific computing users (Eshcer.jl). First tool to invent a server-side virtual DOM (now prevalent in modern frameworks like Phoenix LiveView.)

Skills: Distributed Linear Algebra, Functional Programming, Distributed Computing, Productization and Developer Relations